



Striped hyena

Hyaena hyaena

Found from Africa to Central Asia and India, the striped hyena has the largest range of the world's four hyena species and frequents the widest variety of habitats. However, it is now extinct in many areas and populations are declining in most places. Like other hyenas, the striped hyena resembles a lanky, big-eared dog. Its front legs are longer than those at the back, giving it a front-heavy profile with a sloping back.

Bone cruncher

The striped hyena is primarily a scavenger, using its massively powerful jaw muscles to tear into carcasses, rip apart tough sinews, and crunch up bones. It also hunts small prey and forages for dates, melons, and other fresh fruit. Usually found alone or in small groups, striped hyenas are strictly nocturnal and roam large distances in search of food.

The female gives birth to one to four young in a rocky den or a burrow. The cubs start eating meat when they are around 30 days old. They may suckle for as long as a year while learning important foraging skills from their mother. Most striped hyenas are killed by lions or humans.

↔ 3–4ft (1–1.2m)

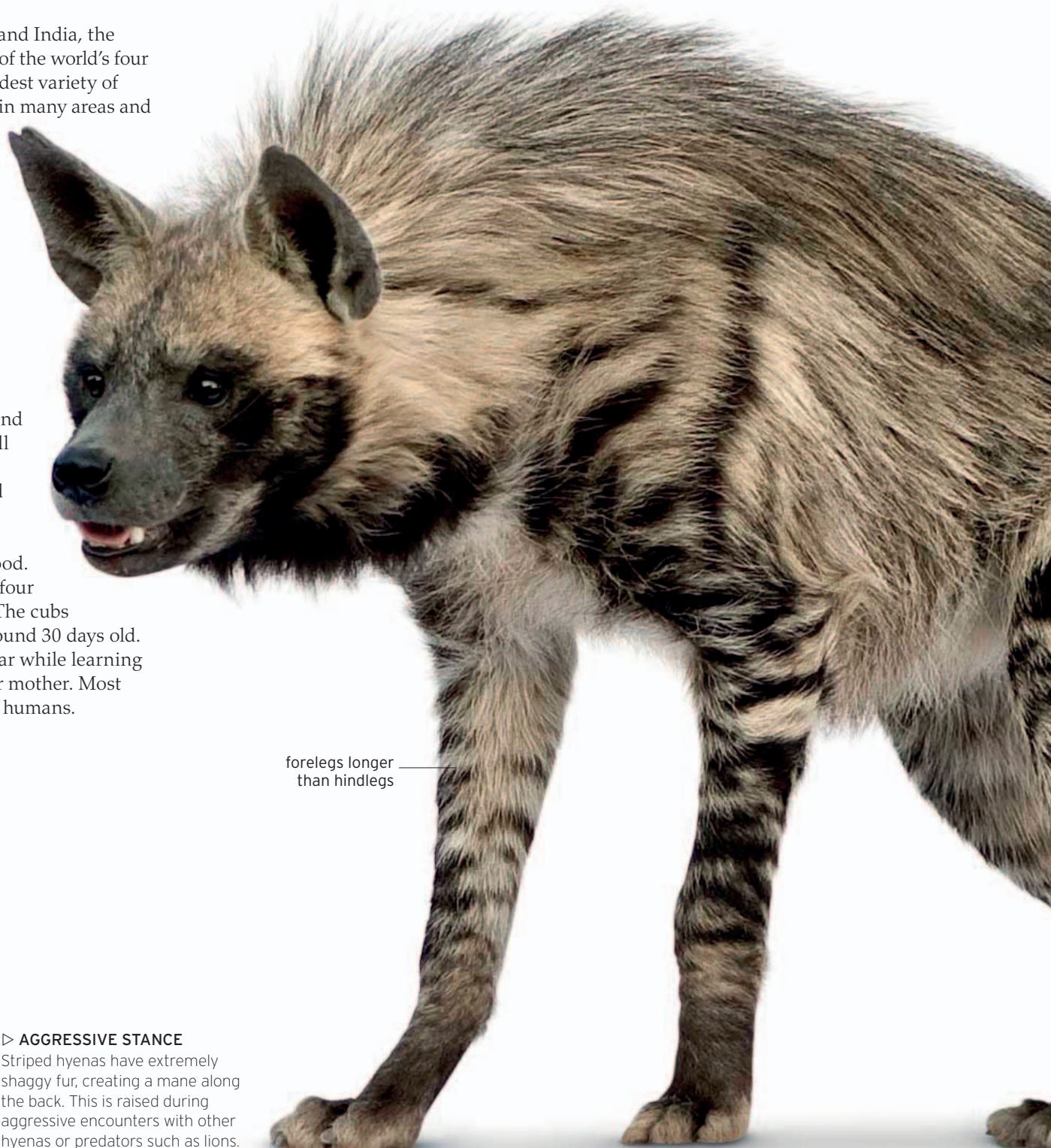
⚖ 57–90lb (26–41kg)

⊗ Near threatened

🍖 Carrion, hares, insects, fruit

🏠

W., N., and E. Africa, W. to S. Asia



▷ **AGGRESSIVE STANCE**
Striped hyenas have extremely shaggy fur, creating a mane along the back. This is raised during aggressive encounters with other hyenas or predators such as lions.

▷ **SPOTTED HYENAS**
Spotted hyenas (*Crocuta crocuta*) are the largest and most powerful members of the hyena family. They are native to sub-Saharan Africa.

